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Interview Questions - QA Engineer

1 message

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To evaluate a QA Engineer candidate effectively, you need a mix of theoretical knowledge, problem-solving skills, and cultural fit. Here are 10 interview questions categorized by type.

Technical Questions

Focus: Testing methodology, automation, and foundational knowledge.

1. What is the difference between Verification and Validation? Can you give a real-world example of each?

* **Why ask:** This tests the candidate's understanding of the fundamental "Quality" vs. "Testing" distinction.

* **What to look for:** Verification is "Are we building the product right?" (reviews, walkthroughs). Validation is "Are we building the right product?" (testing the actual software).

2. Explain the difference between Smoke Testing and Sanity Testing.

* **Why ask:** These terms are often confused. It reveals if the candidate understands the purpose and scope of different test levels.

* **What to look for:** Smoke testing is broad (checking core functionality), while Sanity testing is deep (checking a specific bug fix or new feature).

3. How do you decide which test cases are suitable for automation versus those that should remain manual?

* **Why ask:** Automation is not a silver bullet. You want to see if they understand ROI, test stability, and the limitations of scripts.

* **What to look for:** Candidates should mention regression suites, repetitive tasks, and high-risk areas for automation, while prioritizing exploratory testing and usability for manual efforts.

Scenario Questions

Focus: Analytical thinking and handling real-world friction.

4. Imagine you find a bug that the developer claims is "not a bug" or "works as intended." How do you handle this?

* **Why ask:** This tests communication, diplomacy, and the ability to advocate for the user.

* **What to look for:** A professional approach: checking the requirements documents, gathering evidence/logs, discussing it with the Product Manager, and remaining objective rather than argumentative.

5. We have a release scheduled for tomorrow, but you've just discovered a non-critical UI bug. What is your process for deciding whether to push for a fix or let it go?

* **Why ask:** This tests risk assessment and business awareness.

* **What to look for:** They should talk about assessing the impact (user experience, severity), consulting with stakeholders, and considering the "cost" of delaying the release vs. the "cost" of the defect.

6. If you are given a feature to test with zero documentation, how do you proceed?

* **Why ask:** This tests creativity and the ability to work in ambiguous environments.

* **What to look for:** They should ask for a walkthrough from developers, look at similar existing features, perform exploratory testing, and document their findings as they learn to create a "living" test plan.

7. How would you test a "Login" page? (List at least 5 scenarios.)

* **Why ask:** This tests their ability to think beyond the "happy path."

* **What to look for:** Look for edge cases: valid credentials, invalid password, empty fields, SQL injection attempts, account lockout after failed attempts, and password reset functionality.

Behavioural Questions

Focus: Teamwork, growth, and professional maturity.

8. Tell me about a time you missed a bug that made it into production. How did you handle it, and what did you learn?

* **Why ask:** Everyone misses bugs. This tests accountability and the ability to turn failure into process improvement.

* **What to look for:** Honesty and a focus on "root cause analysis" rather than making excuses. Did they update their test cases? Did they change the testing process to prevent a recurrence?

****9. How do you stay updated with new testing tools and industry trends?****

* ****Why ask:**** The QA landscape changes quickly (CI/CD, AI in testing, etc.). You want someone who is proactive about their learning.

* ****What to look for:**** Mentions of blogs, communities (like Ministry of Testing), certifications, or personal side projects where they experiment with new frameworks (e.g., Playwright, Appium).

****10. Describe a time you had to work closely with a developer to resolve a complex issue. What was your role, and what was the outcome?****

* ****Why ask:**** QA is a collaborative role. You need to ensure they don't see themselves as an "adversary" to developers, but as a partner.

* ****What to look for:**** Empathy, clear communication of technical findings, and a focus on the shared goal of delivering a high-quality product.